

Expenses	Monthly Amount
Miscellaneous	
Newspapers, magazines	
Church tithes	
Cigarettes and alcohol	
Vacation	
Christmas	
Childcare, counseling	
School tuition	
All credit payments	
Total monthly expenses (B)	
Total net monthly income (A)	
Difference: (A–B)	

Once you have finished this projected budget, you need to compare it to the budget you completed in Chapter 2. Put side-by-side, the pre- and post-divorce budgets will clearly show how your financial state of affairs will change if you decide to split up. Sometimes the resultant hardships are determined to be worse than the current situation. This reality may affect your ultimate decision to separate and may encourage you to try and work out the issues in your marriage.

In Kayla's case, she had always paid the bills in the family since she was extremely organized. Her husband, Matt, was focused on the big picture and not into the details. This tendency, she believed, caused him to be careless. One day while paying the credit card bills, she noticed a charge for a trip to Las Vegas (although he claimed to have taken a business trip to Cincinnati), a flower shop, and a lingerie boutique. This was how she learned her husband was having an affair.

